

Cassie and Romulus

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From [Rumors of Polar Bears \(one-act\)](#).

Cassie, mid-teens, approaches Romulus, same age. Romulus writes in a small, ratty notebook.

They are among a group of teens surviving in the aftermath of a major climate induced catastrophe, though Cassie comes from New San Francisco, where Romulus has arrived as part of a teen survivor group. ***Rumors of Polar Bears (one-act)*** is published by Playscripts. [Click here to purchase a copy.](#)

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CASSIE

Dinner's almost ready.

ROMULUS

Not from a can?

CASSIE

Not from a can. What's that?

ROMULUS

Helps me remember things.

CASSIE

What kind of things?

ROMULUS

Things I don't want to forget.

(There's an awkward silence.)

CASSIE

So...your sister and my sister...meow!

(She makes clawing gestures in the air.)

ROMULUS

Sorry about that.

CASSIE

Not your fault.

(Another awkward silence. There's a hint of attraction in the air.)

What's it like?

ROMULUS

What?

CASSIE

Out there.

(Romulus shrugs.)

What's that mean?

ROMULUS

Sometimes stuff just is, you know?

CASSIE

Is good or is bad?

ROMULUS

How come there's no other guys?

CASSIE

Sometimes stuff just is.

(Beat.)

There were, where we used to be. The twins, Matthew and Luke. Then there was John...and Peter. Peter was the funny one.

He'd find these dead flowers on the ground, and he'd try to water them with spit and give them to me. One time, his mouth is so dry, there's hardly any spit and what there is can't get into the air—only he doesn't know it.

And so he smiles and gives me these dead dandelions and then he realizes he's got this glob all over his chin, and he's trying to get it with his tongue while he's still smiling and bowing and holding out the flowers.

I'm like, "Peter, I think the dandelions could use a few more drops." And he says, "I think you're right." And he wipes them on his chin and put them in my hand.

(Beat.)

He was the first to go. Andi says that's so he could be at the gates for us. I don't know what that means. I just know he's gone.

ROMULUS

He sounds pretty cool.

(Cassie nods.)

CASSIE

And then we left and found this place.

ROMULUS

Why do they say you see things?

CASSIE

Because I do.

ROMULUS

How?

(Cassie shrugs.)

CASSIE

(Beat.)

I've got some pictures before the—Andi calls it Tipping Day.

ROMULUS

You've got pictures?

CASSIE

(Continuing her thought:)

Like it was happening a little all the time. Just a little. So little you don't even notice. Until one day it just...tipped.

(She pantomimes a tipping motion with her hands.)

ROMULUS

I want to see the pictures.

CASSIE

It's almost like that here. Like it was before.

ROMULUS

Please.

CASSIE

I can show you.

ROMULUS

I'd like that.

(He reaches out and takes her hand.)